

or added by photographing the card with the iSight camera or by manually entering it. Passbook can store up to eight cards with one set as your default card. All financial information is stored locally on a special Secure Element chip on the iPhone and never passed over to Apple servers further ensuring security. The card information is encrypted and tied to layers of dynamic authentication codes which makes your identity and financial information secure even from merchants. And since Apple has already struck deals with the major credit and debit card services like Visa, MasterCard and American Express and banks like Citibank and Chase, there is no shortage of coverage for users. For now all these deals are only taking place in America and will take some time to transition over to other parts of the world.



Contactless payments thanks to NFC technology.

In conjunction with Apple Watch we can see the futuristic feel that Apple Pay might provide. Payments with just a tap to the screen or a slide of the finger. It seems pretty nifty but again doesn't seem worth the hefty price tag of the Apple Watch. But something worth noting is that until the Software Development Kit comes out for Watch based apps we can only guess the degree to which the device will be used - either just dependent on iPhone or with any autonomy of its own.

There is a lot of nay-saying as far as the Watch is concerned. Yes, the dependency on the iPhone is problematic. Yes, the limited aspects of health-care don't really warrant the cost. And yes, the Apple Pay system can be used over iPhone as well, so why bother with the Watch? The answers to all these are not entirely clear but the questions do deserve the attention they're gathering.

The likely scenario is that the initial release of the Apple Watch will count on the fandom and high initial sales to acclimatise the user base to the form factor and ease of use. In a short enough time when the device has been assimilated a newer model will be released that will feature far more functionality and perhaps even autonomy from the iPhone. The ability of a digital watch to be more than just a health accessory or a payment button or a style